

Hollister CA PD Transparency Portal

Last updated: Thu Nov 05 2026

Hollister CA PD utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, Hollister CA PD utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

Community Impact

Featured Success Stories

Success Story: Shooting Suspect Arrest

PRESS RELEASE
#23-015

POLICE FOLLOW-UP ON SHOOTING

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – December 7, 2023 – On December 4th at 5:21 pm, Hollister Police officers responded to the 800 block of Westside Blvd. regarding the report of a shooting. The investigation revealed that a silver vehicle pulled up next to two occupants in another vehicle and fired several rounds from a handgun into that vehicle. There were no major injuries reported.

Officer Bryce Morgan conducted follow-up investigation using the city's newly installed FLOCK cameras, an Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system, and was able to determine the exact vehicle involved in the shooting. That information led our patrol officers to respond to Watsonville, where we arrested one juvenile suspect with the assistance of the Watsonville Police Department and Santa Cruz Probation. We transported that minor back to San Benito County for booking at the Youth Services Center.

On December 6th, our officers traveled back to Watsonville with a search warrant for a residence in unincorporated Watsonville. With the assistance of the Santa Cruz County Sheriff's Office, we located the suspect vehicle from the shooting and seized it as evidence.

The FLOCK network, recently approved by the City Council, is still in the installation process. The cameras, along with the Raven gunshot detection system is being installed around the city. Fortunately, the camera close to the shooting had recently been made operational.

"FLOCK Systems were integral to our solving this case so quickly." said Hollister Police Chief Carlos Reynoso. "We used

this system exactly as intended; to identify suspects in crimes and build a criminal case against them, and bring them to justice swiftly." He added, "I want to extend our thanks to Watsonville Police officers, deputies from the Santa Cruz Sheriff's Office, and Santa Cruz Probation officers for their assistance."

This investigation is ongoing. Anyone with information regarding these investigations are requested to contact The Hollister Police Department at 831-636-4331. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward.
# # # #
Prepared by: B. Leland, Sergeant
Approved by: C. Reynoso, Chief of Police

Suspect Identified

POLICE UTILIZE FLOCK TO IDENTIFY SUSPECT

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – February 28, 2024 – Hollister Police Department identified a suspect responsible for a vehicle burglary on a victim's work truck utilizing the FLOCK Camera System.

On February 06, 2024, at about 01:05 AM, a Hollister PD Patrol Sergeant interrupted a vehicle burglary in progress that was occurring in the 700 block of La Baig. The patrol sergeant attempted to conduct a vehicle stop on the suspects, but they were able to evade him fleeing at a high rate of speed.

Officer A. McKinney was able to review the patrol sergeant's dash camera system and identify the last 3 digits of the license plate number of the suspect vehicle. Officers used the City of Hollister's newly installed FLOCK Camera System and were able to isolate the identity of the suspect vehicle used in this crime. The suspect vehicle had driven through a location where a Flock camera system was located. The suspect vehicle utilized in the vehicle burglary was identified as a rental vehicle registered out of Oklahoma.

Records supervisor V. Reyna was able to identify the vehicle was an Enterprise rental vehicle. The vehicle had been rented from Enterprise in San Francisco, but Enterprise would not release the renter's information without a search warrant. Officer P. Torres completed a search warrant to obtain the renter's information. Enterprise then provided officer P. Torres with the renter's identity. Utilizing law enforcement resources officers were able to obtain the renter's driver's license number. After reviewing the driver's license photo, the renter was immediately identified as one of the suspects involved in the vehicle burglary.

The charges for this crime are being forwarded to the San Benito County District Attorney's Office for an arrest warrant on the suspect. Further follow-up is being conducted to identify the second individual involved in the vehicle burglary.

Anyone with information regarding this investigation is requested to contact The Hollister Police Department at 831-636-4330. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward.

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Prepared by: Sergeant Michael Paddy Approved by Chief Carlos Reynoso

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Recent Success Story Attempted Murder

POLICE INVESTIGATE ROBBERY/ATTEMPT MURDER

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – March 19, 2024 – On March 18, police were dispatched to a report of a woman driving with a male hanging on to the hood of her vehicle. The male was thrown from the vehicle and sustained life-threatening injuries. A suspect was later located and arrested.

On March 18th at about 6:40 pm, Hollister Police Officers responded to a report of a female driving in the areas of Fourth Street and then Central Avenue with a male hanging on to the hood of her vehicle. Officers arrived in the area and located the victim, who had fallen from the car and was lying in the roadway with witnesses tending to him. The Hollister Fire Department and American Medical Response arrived on scene and rendered aid to the victim. The victim was flown by air ambulance to Natividad Hospital with life threatening injuries.

Witnesses provided officers with the suspect vehicle description and a license plate number. The license plate number indicated the car was registered to an address in Vallejo, CA. Officers immediately entered this information into the FLOCK Camera System, which is a license plate reading camera system recently installed in Hollister. The FLOCK system captured a recording of the suspect vehicle entering Hollister prior to the crime. While searching the local area for the vehicle, officers received an alert on the Gilroy FLOCK system indicating the suspect vehicle had just been in their cameras. A “Be on the Lookout” (BOL) alert was broadcast to our allied agencies between Hollister and Vallejo, CA.

An officer from the California Highway Patrol (Gilroy/Hollister area office) spotted the suspect vehicle traveling northbound on Highway 101 and stopped it in Morgan Hill. A Hollister officer responded to the scene of the stop and took custody of the driver and the vehicle. The suspect was identified as April Garcia (24) from Vallejo, CA. She was transported back to Hollister and booked at the San Benito County Jail on multiple charges including attempted murder and robbery.

During the investigation, officers learned there appeared to be some transaction between the suspect and victim. When the suspect drove away with the victim’s money, he jumped on the vehicle hood trying to stop her. The suspect allegedly drove for about ¾ of a mile at high speeds before the victim fell from the hood to the pavement.

We would like to thank those witnesses who called and provided us with the information used to locate the suspect. We would also like to thank the Gilroy Police Department for their assistance with the FLOCK system and California Highway Patrol for assisting us with the stop and detention of the suspect.

This is an ongoing investigation. Anyone with information regarding this investigations is requested to contact The Hollister Police Department at 831-636-4331. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward.

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Prepared by: Christopher Wells, Senior Officer
Approved by: Carlos Reynoso, Chief of Police
#24-006

Success Story: Flock Arrest of Two Suspects

Vehicle Pursuit Results in Arrest of Two Suspects

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – May 29, 2025 - The Hollister Police Department’s FLOCK system reported a wanted vehicle had entered the City of Hollister. Officers located the vehicle and attempted to stop it. The driver refused to stop and after a short pursuit, the vehicle and the occupants were arrested and charged with multiple crimes. Police recovered nearly 100 pieces of stolen mail and personal documents from addresses around Santa Clara County.

On Wednesday, May 28th, 2025, at about 3:00 PM, officers began to receive Flock Safety system alerts indicating that a wanted felony vehicle had entered the City of Hollister’s jurisdiction at the west end of Hollister. The Flock system is a series of cameras strategically positioned around the city that document license plates and alert police to reported stolen cars or other wanted vehicles in the city.

The suspect vehicle, a Dodge Durango SUV, was being driven around causing continuous activations of the department’s Flock Safety alert system. Officer McKinney was on patrol and responded to the area to find it.

Upon arriving in the area, Officer McKinney located the blue Dodge Durango and initiated a traffic enforcement stop. The driver of the Dodge immediately began to evade Officer McKinney through the streets of Westside Boulevard and Central Avenue. The suspect driver neglected to stop at a posted stop sign at Locust Avenue and Fourth Street and crashed into two vehicles. The driver and passenger of the Dodge fled from the vehicle.

Officer McKinney chased the driver on foot and quickly took him into custody. He was later identified as Jose Cervantes (30) of San Jose. Officers Anderson, Officer Gorman, and Officer Ramos arrived at the scene and began to assist in the care of the other parties involved from the collision. Officer Ramos received information by a community member that the female passenger may be hiding in the backyard of a home on Fourth Street. Officer Ramos later located and arrested the female, Mayra Aguirre (30), of Gilroy.

As officers continued their investigation into this matter, it was discovered the vehicle was allegedly involved in another vehicle pursuit with the Gilroy Police Department earlier in the week. While officers were processing the car, they found nearly 100 pieces of personal documents, credit cards, social security cards, checks, and other mail in the vehicle from addresses around Santa Clara County. The evidence was indicative of mail and identity theft ring. Additionally, narcotics were found in the vehicle and Cervantes was also a parolee released to the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation's (CDCR) Post Release Community Supervision (PRCS) program from Santa Clara County.

The occupants of the other involved vehicles were provided medical treatment by Hollister Fire EMTs and AMR paramedics. They reported minor injuries and were treated and released.

Cervantes and Aguirre were transported to Hazel Hawkins Memorial Hospital for medical evaluation. Cervantes and Aguirre were booked into the San Benito County Jail for a combined total of four felony charges and five misdemeanor charges, ranging from evading a police officer with wanton disregard, hit and run collision, drug charges, DUI and possession of stolen property.

Anyone with information regarding this investigation is asked to contact the Hollister Police Department at 831-638-4331. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward.

# # # #

Prepared by: Senior Officer Staci Esqueda
Approved by: Chief Carlos Reynoso

25-1164

Recent Success Story: Shooting Suspect Arrest

UPDATE-Police Arrest Suspect in July Drive-by Shooting
HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – August 6, 2025 – Hollister Police Detectives have arrested a suspect from the Fourth of July drive by shooting on San Benito Street.

Background: On July 4, 2025, at approximately 9:15 PM, Hollister Police officers responded to the 1000 block of San Benito Street following reports of a drive-by shooting. Upon arrival, officers located a 15-year-old male who had sustained a head injury, likely caused by shattered glass from a vehicle struck by gunfire. Emergency personnel from Hollister Fire and AMR provided on-site treatment, and it was confirmed that three individuals were victims of this violent incident. Fortunately, none of the injuries were life-threatening.

Officers processed the scene and canvased the neighborhood for evidence and witness statements. Through investigative efforts, including intelligence support and residential video footage, detectives identified the suspect vehicle as a white sedan with dark-tinted windows. The suspect remained at large during the early stages of the investigation.

Update: The Hollister Police Bureau continued to pursue the case and, with the assistance of city-owned surveillance cameras and the department's Flock Safety system, confirmed the suspect vehicle. Detectives further identified the front passenger, reported by the victims as the shooter, through footage captured by the city's downtown surveillance network. Hollister Police Detectives worked diligently, following leads and conducting surveillance operations to properly identify the suspect.
Over the course of the investigation, detectives authored more than six search warrants and dedicated extensive time and resources to plan on the safe apprehension of the dangerous individual responsible. On August 6, 2025, Ruben Eduardo Vargas (30 years), a Hollister resident, was arrested and booked into the San Benito County Jail for attempted murder.

The Hollister Police Department would like to thank the Hollister Police Detectives for their dedication and the San Benito County Sheriff's Office for their assistance in executing multiple search warrants throughout the investigation. This is still an ongoing case, and the driver of the vehicle is still at large.
Anyone with information regarding this investigation is requested to contact Detective Gaeta at 831-636-4330. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward of up to $1,000.

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Prepared by: A. Melgoza, Sergeant
Approved by: Carlos Reynoso, Chief of Police

Recent Success Story: Grand Theft Arrest

Police use FLOCK to make Grand Theft Arrest
HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – February 4, 2026 - The Hollister Police Department successfully utilized proactive investigative techniques and Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR) technology to arrest two suspects in connection with a catalytic converter theft and related criminal offenses.

On February 2, 2026, Senior Officer P. Torres responded to and documented a reported theft of a catalytic converter that occurred during the early morning hours in Hollister. Through a detailed review of video surveillance footage provided by the victim and the strategic use of Flock Safety License Plate Reader cameras, Officer Torres identified and developed an investigative lead involving a suspect vehicle observed leaving the area at the time of the theft. The vehicle was subsequently determined to be registered to a residence in the City of Merced.

On February 4, 2026, at approximately 2:00 a.m., Officer Cruz received a real-time alert from the Flock Safety LPR system indicating the suspect vehicle had re-entered the City of Hollister. At approximately 3:22 a.m., Officer Cruz located the vehicle occupied by two individuals and conducted a traffic stop for an observed traffic violation near the intersection of Bridgevale Road and Graf Road. Officers Ramos and Robledo assisted to ensure the stop was conducted safely and effectively.

During contact with the vehicle’s occupants, officers observed a catalytic converter in plain view on the rear seat of the vehicle. Based on this observation, officers conducted a lawful probable cause search, which resulted in the recovery of the catalytic converter, burglary tools commonly used in catalytic converter thefts, controlled substances, and drug paraphernalia. Officers suspect the recovered catalytic converter may be from another currently unreported theft and stolen earlier that night.

The driver, David Baker (30) of Merced, and the passenger, Mee Xiong (38) of Merced, were arrested and booked on multiple charges, including grand theft, conspiracy to commit a felony, possession of burglary tools, possession of a controlled substance, and possession of drug paraphernalia. Xiong was determined to be on active probation out of Merced, California.

The Hollister Police Department commends Officers P. Torres, Cruz, Ramos, and Robledo for their coordinated investigative efforts, attention to detail, and effective use of technology, which directly led to the identification, apprehension, and arrest of the suspects. This case highlights the value of modern law enforcement tools, such as the Flock Safety License Plate Reader Camera System, when combined with skilled police work.

The Hollister Police Department remains committed to transparency and privacy protections. Flock Safety LPR data collected in Hollister is not shared with federal agencies or agencies outside the State of California.

# # # #
Prepared by: Sergeant David Anderson
Approved by: Chief Carlos Reynoso Case # 26-0190

Recent Success Story: Arrest Stalking, Sexual Extortion, et. al. suspect

Pennsylvania Arrest Wanted Suspect Utilizing Flock Cameras
HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – February 12, 2026 - The Hollister Police Department executed an arrest warrant issued by the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania by utilizing the Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR).

On February 11, 2026, the Hollister Police Department was contacted by the Allegheny County Police Department, which had secured an arrest warrant for Michael Anthony Vaca following an extensive investigation into allegations of 55 offenses, including sexual extortion, terroristic threats, stalking, criminal coercion, and harassment.

Recognizing the severity of the charges, Hollister officers immediately confirmed the warrant and coordinated with Pennsylvania authorities. Officers entered the suspect vehicle’s information into the Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR) system to assist in locating Vaca.

At approximately 3:02 p.m. on February 12, officers received an immediate, real-time alert from the Flock Safety LPR

system indicating the suspect vehicle was traveling within the City of Hollister. Officers quickly converged on the area of the alert and located the vehicle in the 800 block of Buena Vista Road. A traffic stop was conducted without incident, and Vaca was safely taken into custody.

Vaca was subsequently transported to the San Benito County Jail for booking and to complete the extradition proceedings to Pennsylvania.

This case demonstrates how critical real-time technology and strong interagency partnerships are in today's law enforcement environment. The Flock Safety License Plate Reader system gave our officers immediate, actionable information that allowed them to safely locate and arrest a suspect accused of serious crimes. Our priority is protecting our community and ensuring individuals who may pose a threat are held accountable, no matter where the warrant originates.

This arrest underscores the powerful combination of proactive police work, interstate collaboration, and responsible technology use. The rapid notification provided by the Flock Safety LPR system enabled officers to act swiftly to remove a wanted suspect from the streets.

The Hollister Police Department remains committed to transparency and privacy protections. Flock Safety LPR data collected in Hollister is not shared with federal agencies or agencies outside the State of California.

# # # #
Prepared by: Sergeant Staci Esqueda
Approved by: Chief Carlos Reynoso Case # 26-0268

Recent Success Story: Assault with Deadly Weapon arrest

Hollister Police Arrest Assault with a Deadly
Weapon Suspect Following FLOCK Alert

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – May 8, 2026 – In the early morning hours of May 5, 2026, Hollister Police officers arrested a suspect wanted in connection with an Assault with a Deadly Weapon investigation after the suspect vehicle was identified by the department's FLOCK camera system on the north side of the city.

On May 3, 2026, Hollister Police officers responded to the 1100 block of San Felipe Road regarding an assault investigation. During the investigation, officers determined that Sylvia Gonzalez, 44, allegedly attempted to strike her ex-boyfriend with a vehicle while he was riding a bicycle nearby.

According to investigators, Gonzalez drove dangerously close to the victim as he was riding his bicycle. The victim then stepped off the bicycle but remained holding onto the handlebars when Gonzalez allegedly drove back toward him, striking the bicycle. The bicycle became lodged underneath the suspect vehicle and was dragged a short distance before Gonzalez reversed, dislodged the bicycle, and fled the scene. The victim was not injured during the incident.

As part of the follow-up investigation, officers entered the suspect vehicle's license plate information into the FLOCK Camera System. At approximately 2:00 a.m. on May 5, 2026, Sergeant Bo Leland received an alert indicating the vehicle had been detected on the north side of Hollister. Sgt. Leland responded to the area, located the vehicle on Santa Ana Road, conducted a traffic stop, and ultimately arrested Gonzalez without incident.

Gonzalez was booked into the San Benito County Jail on a charge of Assault with a Deadly Weapon.

"Technology such as the FLOCK Camera System plays an important role in helping our officers identify suspects and solve crimes," said Hollister Police Chief Carlos Reynoso. "In this case, the quick coordination between technology and officer response allowed us to safely locate and arrest a violent suspect before anyone else could be harmed."

This investigation is ongoing. Anyone with information regarding these investigations are requested to contact The Hollister Police Department at 831-636-4331. Persons wishing to remain anonymous may call WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided to WeTip may qualify for a reward.

Approved by: R. Betanio, Captain

Recent Success Story: Brandishing a Firearm Arrest

Man Arrested After Brandishing Firearm

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA – June 26, 2026 – On June 19, 2026, Officers Baugher, Hernandez, and Guerrero responded to a report of a man brandishing a firearm and challenging two men to fight outside a local business.

The investigation revealed that the altercation began after the suspect's stepdaughter became involved in a verbal dispute with two men inside the business. Believing she was being harassed, she contacted her stepfather and asked him to come to the location. Upon arriving, the suspect allegedly confronted the two men, brandished a firearm, and challenged them to fight. Fearing for their safety, the victims immediately contacted the Hollister Police Department. Prior to officers arriving, the suspect and the female left the scene.

The victims provided officers with detailed descriptions of the suspect, his vehicle, the vehicle's license plate number, and video footage of the incident. Officers utilized the FLOCK Safety camera system and determined it had left the City of Hollister shortly after the incident. The information captured by the camera system allowed investigators to confirm the vehicle's identifying information and identify the registered owner.

On June 25, 2026, officers located the suspect's vehicle and conducted a traffic stop to serve a search warrant for the firearm used during the incident. The driver was identified as Reginald Mendoza Vergara, 45, the registered owner of the vehicle, who also matched the individual captured in the victims' video footage. Mendoza Vergara was taken into custody, and the firearm was recovered and seized as evidence. He was booked into the San Benito County Jail on charges of brandishing a firearm and making criminal threats.

This incident serves as an important reminder that arguments and disagreements, even those that begin as relatively minor disputes, can quickly escalate into dangerous and potentially tragic situations when a firearm is introduced unlawfully. No disagreement is worth risking serious injury or loss of life. The Hollister Police Department encourages community members to resolve conflicts peacefully and reminds firearm owners of the significant legal and personal consequences associated with using a firearm to intimidate or threaten others.

Anyone with information related to this case is encouraged to contact the Hollister Police Department at (831) 636-4331.

Individuals wishing to remain anonymous may contact WeTip at (800) 78-CRIME. Information provided anonymously through WeTip may be eligible for a reward.
# # # #
Prepared by: Sergeant Staci Esqueda
Approved by: Chief Carlos Reynoso #26-1392

Police use FLOCK to Help Recover Stolen Vehicle and Arrest Four Suspects

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA September 1, 2026 – The Hollister Police Department successfully utilized Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR) technology, combined with proactive police work and traditional investigative techniques, to locate a stolen vehicle, recover it for its owner, and arrest four individuals associated with the theft.

The incident provides an example of how LPR technology can be used as an investigative tool to assist officers in responding to reported crimes while maintaining appropriate privacy protections and focusing on specific investigative leads.

At approximately 11:05 a.m. on August 30, 2026, the Hollister Police Department received a report of a black 2003 Chevrolet Silverado that had been stolen sometime during the overnight hours. Officer Buzzetta utilized the Department's Flock Safety LPR system to determine whether the stolen vehicle had been detected by the system. The vehicle had been recorded traveling earlier in the morning in the area of San Felipe Road in Hollister.

Using that information as an investigative lead, Officer Buzzetta conducted a search of the surrounding area and located the stolen Silverado parked and unoccupied in the rear of the Hollister Inn parking lot, located at 152 San Felipe Road.

At approximately 11:56 a.m., Officer Buzzetta positioned himself near the parking lot exit and monitored the vehicle while waiting to determine whether it would leave the area. Approximately three minutes later, the Silverado was driven toward the exit. When the occupants apparently noticed the marked patrol vehicle, the truck reversed back into the motel parking

lot.

Officer Buzzetta entered the parking lot and attempted to conduct a traffic stop. The four occupants immediately exited the stolen vehicle and fled on foot in multiple directions. Officer Buzzetta pursued one of the occupants and took a 17-year-old male into custody. Meanwhile, Officers Robledo and Pompa began searching the surrounding area for the remaining suspects.

The Department subsequently received information that two of the suspects had entered the Taco Bell restaurant at 40 San Felipe Road. As officers approached the restaurant, the two suspects again fled, entering a blue Honda that was waiting in the Quick Stop parking lot at 10 San Felipe Road.

Officers Robledo and Pompa detained both individuals. One was identified as 19-year-old Joshua Gonzales, who was identified as the driver of the stolen Silverado. The second individual was identified as a 17-year-old male passenger. Both were taken into custody.

Sergeant Anderson continued the search for the fourth suspect and located the 16-year-old male suspect in the area behind the Hollister Inn and he was taken into custody.

The stolen Chevrolet Silverado was recovered and subsequently returned to its owner. All the suspects were arrested on multiple charges related to the possession of the stolen vehicle, resisting arrest and the driver was also charges with contributing to the delinquency of a minor.

This incident demonstrates the value of technology when it is used appropriately as one component of a broader law-enforcement investigation. In this case, the Flock Safety LPR system provided officers with an investigative lead after a stolen vehicle was reported. Officers then independently located the vehicle, conducted surveillance, responded to the suspects' actions, pursued the fleeing individuals, and ultimately made the arrests.

Flock Safety LPR technology does not identify a person's identity, determine a person's guilt, or make arrests. It provides officers with information that can assist them in locating vehicles associated with reported crimes and developing investigative leads.

The Hollister Police Department remains committed to using technology responsibly, consistent with applicable laws, Department policies, and constitutional protections. The Department also remains committed to transparency and protecting the privacy of members of the community.

Flock Safety LPR data collected by the Hollister Police Department is not shared with federal agencies or with agencies outside the State of California. For more information, please visit our transparency page at https://transparency.flocksafety.com/hollister-ca-pd

The Hollister Police Department commends Officer Buzzetta, Officers Robledo and Pompa, and Sergeant Anderson for their coordinated response, persistence, and professionalism throughout the investigation.

Police use FLOCK to Help Recover Stolen Vehicle and Arrest Two Suspects

HOLLISTER, CALIFORNIA September 6, 2026 – The Hollister Police Department successfully utilized Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR) technology, combined with proactive police work and traditional investigative techniques, to locate a stolen vehicle, recover it for its owner, and arrest two individuals associated with the theft.

The incident provides an example of how LPR technology can be used as an investigative tool to assist officers in responding to reported crimes while maintaining appropriate privacy protections and focusing on specific investigative leads.

At approximately 11:14 a.m. on September 6, 2026, the Hollister Police Department started receiving Flock Safety LPR alerts of a stolen white Hyundai hatchback driving in the City of Hollister. Officer Campos utilized Santa Cruz 9-1-1 (SCR911) and the Merced Police Department to conduct a record check on the license plate for the Hyundai and to confirm that the vehicle had been stolen on today’s date in Merced.

Using the Flock Safety LPR alerts as an investigative lead, Officer Campos, Senior Officer P. Torres, and Officer Garcia all conducted a search of the surrounding area and located the stolen Hyundai parked and occupied at the gas pumps of the

City Gas Station, located at 5 San Benito Street, at approximately 11:21 a.m.

Officers Campos, P. Torres, and Garcia detained and subsequently arrested two occupants from the vehicle for receiving stolen property. The occupants in possession of the stolen Hyundai were identified as 35-year-old Gerardo Ruelas Vargas and 25-year-old Christian Villanueva. Both occupants were from Merced. Gerardo Vargas and Christian Villanueva were both booked into the San Benito County Jail for felony charges of receiving stolen property. The Hyundai was located and recovered for the owner.

This incident demonstrates the value of technology when it is used appropriately as one component of a broader law-enforcement investigation. In this case, the Flock Safety LPR system provided officers with an investigative lead after a stolen vehicle was reported. Officers then independently located the vehicle and ultimately made the arrests.

Flock Safety LPR technology does not identify a person's identity, determine a person's guilt, or make arrests. It provides officers with information that can assist them in locating vehicles associated with reported crimes and in developing investigative leads.

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The Hollister Police Department commends Officer Campos, Senior Officer P. Torres, and Officer Garcia for their coordinated response, persistence, and professionalism throughout the investigation.

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26-2021

Stolen Vehicle Pursuit in Hollister, leads to arrest

On September 16, 2026 at approximately 9:45 am, Officers received a Be on a lookout (BOL) for a stolen vehicle from Salinas PD hitting on our FLOCK cameras. Officers continued to monitor FLOCK to see if the vehicle, a white 2011 Infiniti G37, with a CA plate number, would come back into the city. Officer Guerrero responded to the area of Fourth Street and San Benito Street where the vehicle was last indicating on the Flock Network. He located the vehicle occupied and still traveling north on San Benito Street. Officer Guerrero continued behind the vehicle and waited for assisting units to respond. The driver appeared nervous and noticed Officer Guerrero following him.

Officer Guerrero attempted to initiate a stop, but the driver fled north on San Benito and continued onto San Felipe Road. The vehicle continued eastbound on Hwy 156. San Benito SO joined the pursuit, and CHP was notified. However, shortly after entering Hwy 156, the pursuit was terminated due to the reckless driving and speed of the suspected stolen vehicle.

Hollister Police notified surrounding agencies of the suspect vehicle and the direction of travel. CHP units in the Los Banos are located the vehicle, pursued it, and apprehended the suspect identified as Juan Pablo Cisneros.

Officer Guerrero contacted CHP and requested to add charges from the pursuit in Hollister to their case.

We are grateful for Flock and how this valuable tool facilitated the locating of the stolen vehicle in our community and we are mostly grateful to the arrest with no one injured.

We would like to thank our partner agencies, San Benito Sheriff's Office and California Highway Patrol and FLOCK for their assistance in making this arrest.

Suspect in Domestic Violence case arrested while attempting to Flee City

On September 25, 2026, a victim called to report that her partner had hit her face seven to eight times, leaving her with visible bruises. The suspect fled the residence before officers arrived, but dispatch broadcast the vehicle information,

allowing San Benito County Sheriff Office deputies to hear it. SBCSO deputies began tracking the vehicle on FLOCK, which allowed them to locate it leaving out of the City of Hollister. Deputies stopped the suspect's vehicle and detained him. Officer Ramos responded to the deputies' location and arrested the suspect for the domestic violence charges and booked into the county jail.

This teamwork was facilitated because both agencies share a radio frequency and both agencies have access to the Flock Network locally.

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

29

LPR Cameras

Number of LPR cameras only.

29

Unique Vehicles Detected

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

158,425

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

3,136

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to Hollister CA PD data.

Alameda CA PD	Alameda County CA SO
Alhambra CA PD	Amador County CA Sheriff's Office
Anderson CA PD	Angels Camp CA PD
Antioch CA PD	Arcadia CA PD
Arvin CA PD	Atherton CA PD
Atwater CA PD	Auburn CA PD
Avenal CA PD	Azusa CA PD
Bakersfield CA PD	Baldwin Park CA PD

Receiving Network Data From

Organizations sharing their data with Hollister CA PD.

Alhambra CA PD	Amador County CA Sheriff's Office
Anaheim CA PD	Anderson CA PD
Anderson IN PD	Angels Camp CA PD
Antioch CA PD	Atherton CA PD
Atwater CA PD	Auburn CA PD
Azusa CA PD	Bakersfield CA PD
Baldwin County GA SO	Baldwin Park CA PD
Barstow CA PD	Bear Valley Springs CA PD

Barstow CA PD	Beaumont CA PD
Bell Gardens CA PD	Belmont CA PD
Benicia CA PD	Beverly Hills CA PD
Blue Lake Rancheria Tribal PD	Brawley CA PD
Brentwood CA PD	Brisbane CA PD
Buena Park CA PD	Burbank Airport CA PD
Burbank CA PD	CA - Napa Valley College Campus
CA - Wasco PD	CA Iipay Nation of Santa Ysabel
Cal Fire	Cal State San Bernadino CA PD
California Department of Corrections	California Highway Patrol
California State Parks	California State University Long Beach Campus PD
Calistoga CA PD	Campbell CA PD
Capitola CA PD	Carmel CA PD
Cathedral City CA PD	Cerritos College CA PD
Chaffey College PD (CA)	Chino CA PD
Chula Vista CA PD	Citrus Heights CA PD
City of Lemoore CA	City of Newman CA PD
City of Riverside CA PD	City of San Dimas CA (LASD)
Clearlake CA PD	Cloverdale CA PD
Colma CA PD	Colton CA PD
Concord CA PD	Contra Costa County CA SO
Corona CA PD	Coronado CA PD
Costa Mesa CA PD	Cotati CA PD
Covina CA PD	CSU Long Beach PD (CA)
Culver City CA PD	Cypress CA PD
Daly City CA PD	Danville CA PD
Delano CA PD	Desert Hot Springs CA PD
Dinuba CA PD	Dixon CA PD
Downey PD CA	Dublin CA PD (ACSO)
East Bay Parks CA PD	East Palo Alto CA PD
El Cajon CA PD	El Centro CA PD
El Monte CA PD	El Segundo CA PD
Beaumont CA PD	Bell CA PD
Beverly Hills CA PD	Blue Lake Rancheria Tribal PD
Brawley CA PD	Brentwood CA PD
Buena Park CA PD	Burbank CA PD
Cal Fire	Calexico CA PD
California Department of Fish & Wildlife (CA)	California Highway Patrol
California State Parks	Calistoga CA PD
Campbell CA PD	Cathedral City CA PD
Chino CA PD	Chula Vista CA PD
Citrus Heights CA PD	City of Lemoore CA
City of Newman CA PD	City of Pico Rivera CA (LASD)
City of Riverside CA PD	Claremont CA PD
Clearwater FL PD	Cloverdale CA PD
Cobb County GA PD	Colma CA PD
Colton CA PD	Concord CA PD
Contra Costa County CA SO	Corcoran CA PD
Corona CA PD	Coronado CA PD
Costa Mesa CA PD	Covina CA PD
Cypress CA PD	Daly City CA PD
Danville CA PD	deactivated
Del Norte County CA SO	Delano CA PD
Desert Hot Springs CA PD	Dinuba CA PD
Dixon CA PD	Downey PD CA
Dublin CA PD (ACSO)	East Bay Parks CA PD
East Palo Alto CA PD	El Cajon CA PD
El Centro CA PD	El Monte CA PD
El Segundo CA PD	Emeryville CA PD
Escalon CA PD	Escondido CA PD
Fairfield CA PD	Fontana CA PD
Fort Bragg CA PD	Fort Worth TX PD
Fountain Valley CA PD	Fowler CA PD
Fremont CA PD	Fullerton CA PD

Elk Grove CA PD	Emeryville CA PD
Escalon CA PD	Escondido CA PD
Fairfield CA PD	Farmersville CA PD
Folsom CA PD	Fontana CA PD
Foothill-DeAnza CA PD	Fort Bragg CA PD
Foster City CA PD	Fountain Valley CA PD
Fowler CA PD	Fremont CA PD
Fresno CA PD	Fullerton CA PD
Galt CA PD	Garden Grove CA PD
Gilroy CA PD	Glendale CA PD
Glendora (CA) PD	Greenfield CA PD
Grover Beach CA PD	Gustine PD CA
Hanford CA PD	Hayward CA PD
Healdsburg CA PD	Hemet CA PD
Hercules CA PD	Hermosa Beach PD CA
Hillsborough CA PD	Humboldt County CA SO
Huntington Beach CA PD	Imperial City CA PD
Imperial County CA SO	Indio CA PD
Irvine CA PD	Irwindale CA PD
Kern County CA SO	Kings County CA DAs Office
Kings County Sheriff's Office CA	La Habra CA PD
La Mesa CA PD	La Verne CA PD
Laguna Beach CA PD	Lake County CA SO
Lakeport CA PD	Lathrop CA PD
Lincoln CA PD	Lindsay Public Safety Department CA
Livermore CA PD	Livingston CA PD
Lodi CA PD	Lompoc CA PD
Los Alamitos PD CA	Los Altos CA PD
Los Angeles CA PD	Los Angeles County CA SD
Los Angeles Port Police CA	Los Gatos CA
Madera County SO CA	Manteca CA PD
Marin County CA DA	Marin County CA SO
Marina CA PD	Marysville CA PD
Galt CA PD	Garden Grove CA PD
Gilroy CA PD	Glendale CA PD
Glendora (CA) PD	Greenfield CA PD
Grover Beach CA PD	Gustine PD CA
Hanford CA PD	Hayward CA PD
Hemet CA PD	Hercules CA PD
Hillsborough CA PD	Hollister CA PD
Huntington Beach CA PD	Imperial City CA PD
Imperial County CA SO	Indio CA PD
Irwindale CA PD	Kern County CA SO
Kings County CA DAs Office	Kings County Sheriff's Office CA
Kingsburg CA PD	La Habra CA PD
La Mesa CA PD	La Verne CA PD
Laguna Beach CA PD	Lakeport CA PD
Lathrop CA PD	Lincoln CA PD
Lindsay Public Safety Department CA	Livermore CA PD
Lodi CA PD	Lompoc CA PD
Los Alamitos PD CA	Los Angeles Port Police CA
Madera CA PD	Madera County SO CA
Mahoning Twp PA PD	Manteca CA PD
Marysville CA PD	McFarland CA PD
Mendocino County SO-CA	Mendota CA PD
Menifee CA PD	Merced County CA SO
Milpitas CA PD	Modoc County CA SO
Monrovia CA PD	Montclair CA PD
Monterey Park CA PD	Moraga CA PD
Murrieta CA PD	Napa CA PD
Napa County CA SO	National City CA PD
NCRIC	Newark CA PD
Newport Beach PD CA	Novato CA PD
Oakley CA PD	Ontario CA PD
Orange CA PD	Orange County SO CA
Orange Cove CA PD	Oroville CA PD

McFarland CA PD	Mendocino County SO-CA
Mendota CA PD	Menifee CA PD
Menlo Park CA PD	Merced County CA SO
Mill Valley CA PD	Milpitas CA PD
Modoc County CA SO	Monrovia CA PD
Montclair CA PD	Monterey CA PD
Monterey County District Attorney's Office	Moraga CA PD
Morgan Hill CA PD	Murrieta CA PD
Napa CA PD	Napa County (CA) Probation Department
Napa County CA SO	National City CA PD
NCRIC	Nevada City CA PD
Nevada County CA SO	Newark CA PD
Newport Beach PD CA	Novato CA PD
Oakland CA PD	Oakley CA PD
Ontario CA PD	Orange CA PD
Orange County (CA) DA Office	Orange County SO CA
Orange Cove CA PD	Oroville CA PD
Pacific Grove CA PD	Palm Springs CA PD
Palo Alto CA PD	Pasadena CA PD
Petaluma CA PD	Piedmont CA PD
Placentia CA PD	Placer County CA DA Office
Placer County CA SO	Pleasant Hill CA PD
Pleasanton CA PD	Pomona CA PD
Port Hueneme CA PD	Port of Stockton CA PD
Porterville CA PD	Redlands CA PD
Redondo Beach CA PD	Redwood City CA PD
Reedley CA PD	Rialto PD CA
Richmond CA PD	Ridgecrest CA PD
Rio Hondo College PD CA	Rio Vista CA PD
Ripon CA PD	RIV CO ARSON TF CA PD
Riverside County CA SO	Rocklin CA PD
Rohnert Park Department of Public Safety (CA)	Roseville CA PD
Pasadena CA PD	Petaluma CA PD
Placentia CA PD	Placer County CA SO
Pleasant Hill CA PD	Pleasanton CA PD
Pomona CA PD	Port Hueneme CA PD
Port of Stockton CA PD	Porterville CA PD
Redondo Beach CA PD	Reedley CA PD
Ridgecrest CA PD	Rio Hondo College PD CA
Rio Vista CA PD	Riverside County CA SO
Salinas CA PD	San Benito County SO CA
San Bernardino CA PD	San Bernardino County CA SD
San Bruno CA PD	San Diego Harbor CA PD
San Fernando CA PD	San Francisco CA PD
San Gabriel CA PD	San Joaquin CA DA
San Joaquin County CA SO	San Joaquin Delta College PD (CA)
San Jose CA PD	San Leandro CA PD
San Luis Obispo CA PD	San Luis Obispo County (CA) Sheriff
San Pablo CA PD	San Pasqual CA PD
San Ramon CA PD	Sanger CA PD
Santa Barbara County CA SO	Santa Clara CA PD
Santa Monica CA PD	Sarasota FL PD
Sausalito CA PD	Seal Beach CA PD
Seaside CA PD	Selma CA PD
Sequoias Community College District PD	Simi Valley CA PD
Solano County CA SO	Soledad CA PD
Sonoma County CA SO	South Pasadena CA PD
Stallion Springs CA PD	Stockton CA PD
Suisun City CA PD	Sutter County CA SO
Taft CA PD	Tehachapi CA PD
Tehama County CA SO	Tiburon CA PD
Trinity County SO CA	Tulare CA PD
Turlock CA PD	Tustin CA PD
Ukiah Fire CA FD	Union City CA PD

Sacramento CA DA
Sacramento County CA SO
Salinas CA PD
San Benito County SO CA
San Bernardino CA PD
San Bernardino County CA SD
San Bruno CA PD
San Diego CA PD
San Diego County CA SO
San Diego Harbor CA PD
San Fernando CA PD
San Francisco CA PD
San Francisco District Attorney CA
San Gabriel CA PD
San Joaquin CA DA
San Joaquin County CA SO
San Joaquin Delta College PD (CA)
San Jose - Evergreen Community College District PD CA
San Jose CA PD
San Jose State University CA
San Leandro CA PD
San Luis Obispo CA PD
San Luis Obispo County (CA) Sheriff
San Mateo CA PD
San Mateo County CA SO
San Pablo CA PD
San Pasqual CA PD
San Rafael CA PD
San Ramon CA PD
Sand City CA PD
Sanger CA PD
Santa Ana CA PD
Santa Barbara County CA SO
Santa Clara CA PD
Santa Clara County CA SO
Santa Clara DA CA
Santa Maria CA PD
Santa Monica CA PD
Santa Rosa CA PD
Sausalito CA PD
Seal Beach CA PD
Seaside CA PD
Sequoias Community College District PD
Simi Valley CA PD
Solano County CA SO
Solano County DA CA
Soledad CA PD
Sonoma County CA SO
South Pasadena CA PD
South San Francisco CA PD
St. Helena CA PD
Stallion Springs CA PD
Stanford University CA PD
Stockton CA PD
Suisun City CA PD
Sunnyvale CA PD
Sutter County CA SO
Taft CA PD
Tehachapi CA PD
Tiburon CA PD
Town of Woodside CA (SMCSO)
Tracy CA PD
Truckee CA PD
Tulare CA PD
Tulare County CA SO
University of California
Berkeley PD
University of the Pacific (CA)
Upland CA PD
Ventura CA PD
Vernon CA PD
Visalia CA PD
Walnut Creek CA PD
West Covina CA PD
West Sacramento CA PD
West Valley Mission College District PD CA
Westminster CA PD
Westmorland CA PD
Wheatland CA PD
Whittier CA PD
Williams CA PD
Willits CA PD
Winters CA PD
Woodlake CA PD
Woodland CA PD
Yolo County CA SO
Yuba County Sheriffs Office

Turlock CA PD | Tustin CA PD

Ukiah CA PD | Ukiah Fire CA FD

Union City CA PD | Upland CA PD

Vacaville CA PD | Vallejo CA PD

Ventura CA PD | Ventura County CA SO

Ventura County District Attorney's Office CA | Ventura CA PD

Visalia CA PD | Walnut Creek CA PD

Watsonville CA PD | West Covina CA PD

West Sacramento CA PD | West Valley Mission College Dist Campus (CA)

Western States Information Network (CA) | Westminster CA PD

Westmorland CA PD | Wheatland CA PD

Whittier CA PD | Williams CA PD

Willits CA PD | Windsor CA PD

Woodlake CA PD | Woodland CA PD

Yolo County CA SO | Yreka CA PD

Yuba City CA PD | Yuba County Sheriff's Office

Policy & Trust

What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.

Data is owned by Hollister CA PD and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.